

Revolutionizing Poultry Farming

A Deep Dive into Innovative Practices at the State-of-the-Art Hatchery and Brooding Center in the JSB Project, Polonnaruwa District.



Polonnaruwa, a district in the North Central Province of Sri Lanka, faces challenges related to food security, employment, and income generation for its local communities. In response, Mr. H.A. Nimal Dissanayaka initiated the establishment of a hatchery and brooding center with the support of the Japanese Supplementary Budget (JSB) project, backed by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). The goal is to empower local communities through sustainable agriculture, positively impacting the lives of people in Polonnaruwa and contributing to the region's sustainable development.

In the beginning, Nimal's income came from selling eggs, which earned him a modest sum of 5,000 LKR per week. However, his fortunes changed when he was introduced to a United Nations Development Programme project funded by the Japanese Supplementary Budget (JSB) and implemented in Sri Lanka by the Government of Sri Lanka. As a result of his partnership with the project, his weekly income soared to 12,000 LKR. This significant increase was made possible by his collaboration with the project. Taking advantage of the project's incubator support, he started producing day-old and month-old chicks. As a result, he now sells 400 chicks each month at a price of 200 LKR per chick.

In 2023, Mr. Dissanayaka initiated the establishment of a hatchery and brooding center for backyard poultry, supported by the JSB project. The project provided essential equipment, including a 172-capacity incubator and a 200ft² coop. This initiative aimed to make high-quality

day-old chicks more accessible to local farmers, promoting self-sufficiency and reducing dependency on external sources for poultry products.

Today, the farm yields an impressive monthly revenue of nearly 100,000 LKR by selling eggs, chicks, and fulfilling the protein needs of both the family and the local community. The farm collaborates with the Gal Oya Green feed processing center to reduce feed costs, and they use Azolla and BSF larvae as high protein feeds. The hatchery has also played a vital role in helping women in the region increase their flock count and establish smaller-scale poultry farms.



Nimal's farm is a great example of modern poultry farming practices. He has adopted innovative techniques like Azolla farming and BSF larvae farming to provide alternative bird feeds. The JSB project and UNDP provided Nimal with an array of resources such as an incubator, 50 birds for parent stock, 20 one-month-old chicks, cages for brooding, and a poultry feed processing unit. Nimal's family has also been continuously supporting him on his entrepreneurial journey, which has contributed to his farm's success. With their guidance, the possibilities for Nimal and his farm seem endless.